01 WARM / Ivory, Palatino, muted brown

Research with AI Agents

What Works, What It Costs, and What an Institute Needs

Lukas Theissinger

October 30, 2026

Field Report: Automating Exercises

1. **The problem.** PhD student, tutoring an exercise class every two weeks:
   - 2 h exercise class + 6 h preparation (solving the tasks, making the slides)
   - rough estimate: **2 h + 6 h = 8 h every two weeks**
2. **Automate as much as possible.**
   a) Task solving: an agent solves every task, with code and plots
   b) Slide creation: an agent turns the solutions into the class slides
3. **Left to do:** understand the solutions, make small updates to the slides.
   - class stays 2 h, preparation drops from 6 h to 2 h: **2 h + 2 h = 4 h every two weeks**
4. **Ask your agent to try it:** `github.com/Newida/AutomatingExercises` **Avoid:** Don't do anything BY HAND on this project. If you want to change it, ASK YOUR AGENT to change it.

Takeaways

For the individual

1. **You need to use AI agents.**
2. **Use AI agents to change your bottlenecks at work**
3. **Automate, to a degree, only what pays off:**
   how often × time saved > time to build
4. **Agent use is a skill** you need to learn.

For the institute

1. **Automate workflows for every individual:** what never pays off for one person pays off for 10 000.
2. **Provide your employees with agents.**
3. **Consider self-hosting.**

02 JOURNAL / White, Times-style serif, fine rules

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03 STONE / Grey, Charter headings, sans-serif body

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04 SAGE / Soft green, bold serif headings, sans-serif body

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05 INK / Dark graphite, warm serif type

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